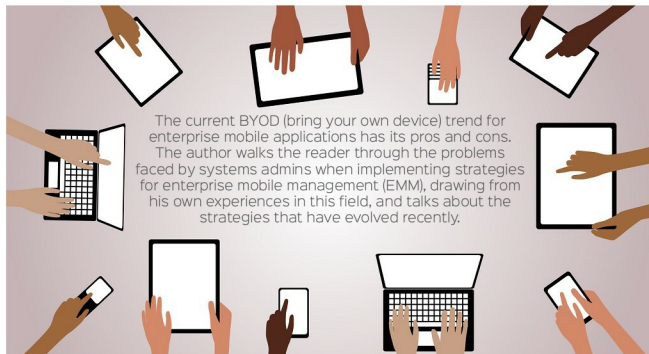


What Enterprise Mobile Management Strategy Should You Adopt for BYOD?



Developers or product managers of enterprise grade mobile apps often wish their apps could be managed by enterprise IT admins using popular Enterprise Mobile Management (EMM) solutions. Similarly, IT admins are on the lookout for the ideal mobile strategy to manage and secure business apps, with data residing on the user's personal mobile device.

Over the course of my work in this domain, I found solutions to address both these important requirements. It happened while working on an assignment to define an extensible mobile strategy for a popular workforce management (WFM) mobile product. The task was to enable it to be managed by IT admins using popular EMM solutions in the market, whether Air-watch (AW), MobileIron (MI), SOTI or SAP Afaria. The major requirement was to enable the IT admin to dynamically configure WFM to set key properties like the server URL from the EMM admin console.

This article is based on my experience from that exercise. It will provide insights to help you decide the best mobile management strategy for your needs. Additionally, it will help you understand the new, standard EMM integration approach by highlighting the pros and cons of each of the legacy EMM integration approaches normally used.

BYOD: Benefits and trends

The use of mobile devices for work operations has become

quite common. In fact, with BYOD (bring your own device), it has become a basic need nowadays.

According to Wikipedia, BYOD refers to the policy of permitting employees to bring personally owned devices (smartphones, tablets, etc) to their workplace, and to use those devices to access privileged company information and applications.

BYOD has resulted in a lot of benefits like:

1. Increased productivity of employees when they work from devices they are familiar with as it helps them complete tasks faster. A survey carried out by Dell and Intel confirms this.
2. Employee satisfaction.
3. Cost reduction—no hardware/COPE (corporate owned personally enabled) device procurement.

Owing to the benefits mentioned, there has been substantial adoption of BYOD in enterprises in the past few years and this is expected to grow even more in the future. According to Gartner, half the employers around the world were operating on the basis of BYOD by the end of 2016, and 90 per cent of organisations will support some aspect of BYOD through 2017.

The need for MDM alternatives for BYOD

Mobile device usage for work has led to IT admins searching for technology solutions to secure these devices and safeguard